

Ethan Tran

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EDUCATION

Diamond Bar High School

High School Diploma, 4.0 GPA, Class Rank 1/620

Relevant Coursework: AP Calculus AB & BC, AP Chemistry, AP Computer Science A, Biology, Computer Systems, Industrial Engineering
AP Scores: AP Calculus BC - 5; AP Calculus AB - 4 (Subscore 5); AP Chemistry - 4; AP Computer Science A - 5; AP English Language and Composition - 5; AP U.S. Government - 5; AP U.S. History - 4; AP European History - 4; AP Precalculus - 4

Diamond Bar, CA

May 2027

Mt. San Antonio College

College Coursework, 4.0 GPA

Relevant Coursework: BIOL 4 (Biology for Majors), AHIS 6 (History of Modern Art), BUSC 1A (Principles of Macroeconomics)

Walnut, CA

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Barron Lab - Stanford School of Medicine

Research Intern | Mentors: Laurent Bekale, PhD; Annelise Barron, PhD

- Investigating binding between the NLRP3 inflammasome, implicated in Alzheimer's disease, and the human peptide LL-37 using protein docking and structural modeling.
- Applying AI-assisted analysis to identify candidate binding sites and evaluate NLRP3 domains, complemented by hands-on laboratory experiments.
- Mapping Alzheimer's-associated genes in collaboration with Dr. James J. Truchard and Benjamin Gustafsson.

Stanford, CA

Jul. 2026 - Present

Computational Biology and Disease Genomics Lab - UC Irvine School of Medicine

Research Intern | Mentors: Ya Allen Cui, PhD (PI); Weifan Yin, MD, PhD

- Conducting a literature review of candidate genes identified through preliminary screening for associations with neurodevelopmental disorders and epilepsy.
- Synthesizing reported disease phenotypes, inheritance patterns, molecular mechanisms, evidence strength, and key references for prioritized genes.
- Using Linux/Bash and R to organize and analyze candidate-gene data and support the literature-review workflow.

Irvine, CA

Jun. 2026 - Present

Calla Lab - UC Riverside Department of Psychology

Research Intern | Mentor: Jasmine Ford; Principal Investigator: Rachel Wu, PhD

- Investigating chronic occupational stress, HPA-axis dysregulation, and cognitive aging, with attention to learning, memory, inflammation, and daily functioning.
- Reviewing evidence on acute versus chronic occupational stress and its long-term neurological and physiological effects in high-stress professions.
- Evaluating current wellness interventions and the potential for lifelong learning to support cognitive functioning and healthy aging.

Riverside, CA

Jun. 2026 - Present

UCSC Science Internship Program (SIP) - CPM-07: AI-Facilitated Group Formation and Project Ideation for Hackathons

Research Intern | Mentor: Alexander Sherbrooke; Faculty Advisor: David Lee, PhD

- Developed an AI/LLM-powered chatbot within the Blossom project to support hackathon group formation and project ideation.
- Selected as one of 320 SIP students from a pool of 4,000+ qualified candidates.
- Built on Blossom, a human-bingo platform that uses pre-event surveys to create personalized connection activities for large events.
- Prompt-engineered LLM outputs and tested AI-generated icebreakers, bonding activities, and ideation experiences for real-world social settings.
- Researched group ideation and collaborative activity design to build on prior work in human-computer interaction and social computing.

Summer 2026

Santa Cruz, CA

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE & VOLUNTEERING

Epic Care

Clinical Observer | Mentor: Bao Dao, MD, Hematologist/Oncologist

- Completed two years of clinical observation under Bao Dao, MD, a hematologist/oncologist, observing patient consultations, cancer diagnostic processes, treatment planning, and oncology care workflows.
- Gained in-depth exposure to chemotherapy protocols and the clinical reasoning involved in patient-centered hematology and oncology treatment decisions.
- Examined how physicians communicate complex diagnoses, treatment options, expectations, and care plans to patients and families with clarity and empathy.

Oakland, CA

Jul. 2024 - Jul. 2026

Pomona Valley Hospital

Volunteer

- Earned 200+ volunteer hours supporting hospital operations and patient-facing services.
- Supported patients directly in the Telemetry Unit by assisting staff with clinical tasks and patient needs.
- Carried out service tasks that improved daily patient, visitor, and staff experiences.

Pomona, CA

Jun. 2024 - Present

American Red Cross	Los Angeles, CA
President & Volunteer	Aug. 2023 - Present
• Earned 250+ volunteer hours through community service, leadership initiatives, and preparedness events. • Completed leadership camp training focused on teamwork, responsibility, and service. • Learned hands-only CPR and supported activities aimed at strengthening community readiness.	

PROJECTS & EXPERIENCE

Personal Portfolio Website	ethanlytran.com
Developer	2026
• Developed and launched ethanlytran.com to showcase my resume, research, projects, leadership, and portfolio. • Designed a multi-page structure to showcase research, projects, leadership experiences, and contact information for programs and opportunities. • Used the website as a digital portfolio for academic programs, internships, leadership roles, and future opportunities.	
Travel Planning Website	Diamond Bar, CA
Developer	2026
• Developed a travel-planning website for my friends and me to organize trips, compare booking options for flights and hotels, and coordinate plans. • Created planning features centered on shared trip information, group decision-making, and a collaborative calendar for upcoming travel. • Focused on making trip planning easier by organizing major travel logistics in one shared online space.	

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

WeBall	Diamond Bar, CA
President	Sep. 2024 - Present
• Organized volunteer basketball events for 50+ club members and created mentorship opportunities for younger students. • Taught hundreds of students basketball fundamentals through outreach programs led by experienced student athletes. • Connected 10+ basketball-experienced players with younger students to build confidence and community engagement.	
Asian Pacific Islander Student Union (APISU)	Diamond Bar, CA
President	Dec. 2024 - Present
• Led cultural-awareness activities highlighting Asian and Pacific Islander traditions, communities, and service initiatives. • Collaborated with officers to plan events, manage meetings, support LA wildfire-related volunteering, and increase student engagement. • Promoted student participation in cultural education and service opportunities across campus.	
Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA)	Diamond Bar, CA
Officer	Nov. 2023 - Present
• Represented Diamond Bar High School in regional and state business competitions spanning financial math, information technology, sports and entertainment management, and digital video production. • Organized a mock competition for 100+ competitors to help students prepare for regionals. • Strengthened leadership, communication, business analysis, and rapid preparation skills through competitive events.	
Diamond Bar High School Basketball Team	Diamond Bar, CA
Varsity Player	Sep. 2023 - Present
• Member of the varsity basketball team while maintaining a rigorous academic course load and consistent training schedule. • Built discipline, resilience, and teamwork by competing in high-pressure athletic environments.	

AWARDS & HONORS

• Brahma Tech Honor Roll (2024, 2025) • Top Ten Student (2024) • Gold Presidential Volunteer Service Award • AP Scholar with Distinction • Humanitarian and International Law Advocate • FBLA - 1st Place, Introduction to Financial Math (Regionals) • FBLA - 4th Place, Sports & Entertainment Management • FBLA - 6th Place, Introduction to Information Technology (Regionals) • FBLA - 9th Place, Digital Video Production (State) • HOSA - 8th Place, Creative Problem Solving (State)	
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SKILLS & INTERESTS

Technical: R, Linux/Bash, Microsoft Office, Excel, LLM prompt engineering, AI chatbot development, website development, computer hardware knowledge & construction
Clinical & Medical: Clinical observation, patient-centered communication, oncology care workflow familiarity, chemotherapy protocol exposure, cancer diagnostic process familiarity, telemetry-unit support, medical literature review, hands-only CPR
Languages: English, Vietnamese, Mandarin
Strengths & Interests: Leadership, teamwork, problem-solving, communication, video games, basketball, baking
Research Interests: Computational biology, disease genomics, Alzheimer's disease, neuroinflammation, protein modeling, and cognitive aging